

Post-incident review PIR-2025-044

Order Management: elevated error rates

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 16 March 2025, Order Management experienced elevated error rates in production (Southeast Asia) for about 25 minutes. A latency threshold alert fired for the service's main endpoint. Investigation found that the database ran out of connections under end-of-month batch load.

Impact

Users of Order Management saw elevated error rates for about 25 minutes. The service owner, Commerce Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:11 First signal received.
- 09:31 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:48 Likely cause identified.
- 10:23 Mitigation applied.
- 10:55 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the database ran out of connections under end-of-month batch load.

The rollback script had never been exercised and failed on first use.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Add a synthetic probe that exercises the affected path every minute.
- Write and rehearse a runbook for this failure mode.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.